

84. Word boundary: `\b`

`\b` bhi `^` aur `$` ki tarah ek **test** hai. Regexp engine `\b` par pahunchta hai to check karta hai ki string me wo position "word boundary" hai ya nahi.

Teen positions word boundary maani jaati hain:

1. String ki **shuruaat**, agar pehla character word character `\w` ho.
2. String ke **beech** me do characters ke beech jahan ek `\w` ho aur doosra nahi.
3. String ke **end** par, agar aakhri character `\w` ho.

Jaise `\bJava\b` `(Hello, Java!)` me mil jaata hai (standalone word), par `(Hello, JavaScript!)` me nahi:

js

```
"Hello, Java!".match(/\bJava\b/); // Java
"Hello, JavaScript!".match(/\bJava\b/); // null
```

`(Hello, Java!)` me `\b` in positions par hai: shuruaat (H se pehle), `(Hello)` ke baad (o aur comma ke beech), `(Java)` se pehle (space aur J ke beech) aur `(Java)` ke baad (a aur `!` ke beech).

To `\bHello\b` match hoga, par `\bHell\b` nahi (`l` ke baad boundary nahi) aur `(Java!\b)` bhi nahi (`!` word character nahi hai, isliye uske baad boundary nahi):

js

```
"Hello, Java!".match(/\bHello\b/); // Hello
"Hello, Java!".match(/\bJava\b/); // Java
"Hello, Java!".match(/\bHell\b/); // null
"Hello, Java!".match(/\bJava!\b/); // null
```

Digits ke saath

`\b` sirf words nahi, digits ke saath bhi. `\b\d\d\b` **akele 2-digit numbers** dhundhta hai (jinke aas-paas `\w` na ho, jaise space, punctuation ya text ka start/end):

js

```
"1 23 456 78".match(/\b\d\d\b/g); // 23,78
"12,34,56".match(/\b\d\d\b/g); // 12,34,56
```

Non-Latin alphabets ke liye `\b` kaam nahi karta

`\b` check karta hai ki position ke ek taraf `\w` ho aur doosri taraf `\w` na ho. Par `\w` matlab Latin letters `[a-z]`, digits, underscore. To Cyrillic letters ya hieroglyphs ke liye ye test kaam nahi karta.

Task: time dhundhna

Format `hours:minutes` (jaise `09:00`), string `Breakfast at 09:00 in the room 123:456.` me se, par `123:456` match **na** ho:

```
js
```

```
/\b\d\d:\d\d\b/ // 09:00
```

(Sahi time hai ya nahi ye check nahi karna, `25:99` bhi chalega abhi.)